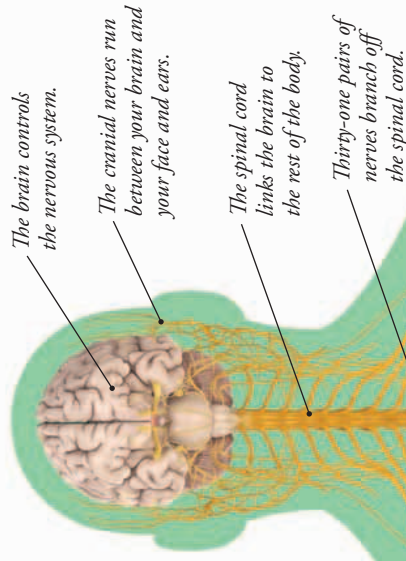


Control network

The human body is controlled by a special network of cells known as the nervous system. The nerve cells that make up this system transmit electrical signals, which dart throughout your body all the time, carrying information from your sense organs to your brain and controlling your organs and muscles.

NERVOUS SYSTEM

All parts of the body are connected to the nervous system. The system's control center is the brain—an incredibly complicated mass of nerve cells that work together like a living computer to process information. Electrical signals from the brain are carried to the rest of the body by nerve cells, which are bundled together to form cables called nerves.



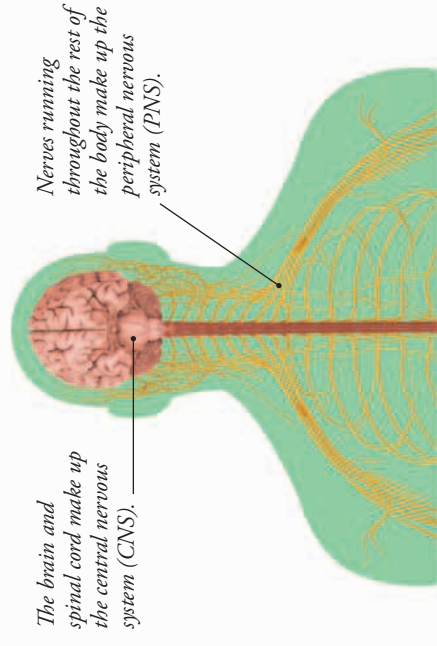
Wow!

A nerve signal travels all the way from the brain to the big toe in just $\frac{1}{100}$ of a second.

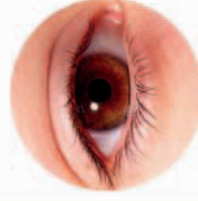
The ulnar nerve runs under a bone called the humerus. If you bump your elbow, the nerve tingles, which is why the humerus is also called the funny bone.

PARTS OF THE NERVOUS SYSTEM

Your nervous system has two main parts. The central nervous system (CNS) is your body's control center and consists of the brain and spinal cord. The peripheral nervous system (PNS) carries signals everywhere else in the body, using cables called nerves. These nerves link the CNS to your sense organs, muscles, and internal organs.



Where nerves lead



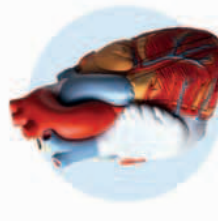
▲ SENSES

Nerves carry incoming signals from sense organs, such as your eyes, to your brain. Your brain then figures out how to respond.



▲ MUSCLES

Nerves also carry outgoing signals from your brain to your muscles to make them move. You control most of your muscles voluntarily.



▲ ORGANS

Internal organs such as your heart are also controlled by nerves. This happens automatically, without your voluntary control.